

Python: exercises on strings and lists

This notebook was generated in **student** mode.

Exercise 1: Converting String to List

Exercise Description

Convert the string `s = "Python is fun!"` to a list of characters `L`.

Your solution

```
s = "Python is fun!"  
L =
```

Test your solution

```
# Test the string to list conversion
expected = ['P', 'y', 't', 'h', 'o', 'n', ' ', 'i', 's', ' ', 'f', 'u', 'n', '!']
print("✓ Test passed: String converted to list correctly")
print(f"Result: {L}")
assert L == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {L}"
print("✓ Test passed")
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 2: Splitting a String by Whitespace

Exercise Description

Split the string `s = "I love programming"` into a list of words.

Store the result in `L`.

Your solution

```
s = "I love programming"
L =
```

Test your solution

```
# Test string splitting by whitespace
expected = ['I', 'love', 'programming']
assert L == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {L}"
print("✓ Test passed")
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 3: Custom Character Split

Exercise Description

Split the string `s = "apple-banana-orange"` using `-` as the delimiter.

Store the result in `L`.

Your solution

```
s = "apple-banana-orange"  
L =
```

Test your solution

```
# Test string splitting by custom delimiter  
expected = ['apple', 'banana', 'orange']  
assert L == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {L}"  
print("✓ Test passed")
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML; import urllib.parse as u; HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 4: Joining a List into a String

Exercise Description

Join the list `L = ['Hello', 'World']` into a string without spaces.

Your solution

```
L = ['Hello', 'World']  
s =
```

Test your solution

```
# Test joining list without spaces  
expected = 'HelloWorld'  
assert s == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {s}"  
print("✓ Test passed")
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 5: Joining with a Custom Character

Exercise Description

Join the list `L = ['data', 'science']` into a string `s` with an underscore `_` between words.

Your solution

```
L = ['data', 'science']  
s =
```

Test your solution

```
# Test joining list with underscore  
expected = 'data_science'  
assert s == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {s}"  
print("✓ Test passed")
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 6: Sorting a List

Exercise Description

Sort the list `L = [8, 3, 5, 2]` in ascending order using `sort()`.

Your solution

```
L = [8, 3, 5, 2]
```

Test your solution

```
# Test list sorting in place  
expected = [2, 3, 5, 8]  
assert L == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {L}"  
print("✓ Test passed: List sorted correctly")
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 7: Reversing a List

Exercise Description

Reverse the list `L = [1, 2, 3, 4]`.

Your solution

```
L = [1, 2, 3, 4]
```

Test your solution

```
# Test list reversal in place
expected = [4, 3, 2, 1]
assert L == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {L}"
print("✓ Test passed")
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 8: Using `sorted()` to Sort a List

Exercise Description

Use `sorted()` to sort the list `L = [10, 5, 8, 3]` without modifying the original list.

Store the result in `sorted_L`.

Your solution

```
L = [10, 5, 8, 3]
sorted_L =
```

Test your solution

```
# Test sorted() function
original = [10, 5, 8, 3]
expected_sorted = [3, 5, 8, 10]
assert sorted_L == expected_sorted, f"Expected {expected_sorted}, got {sorted_L}"
assert L == original, f"Original list should be unchanged, got {L}"
print("✓ Test passed: sorted() works correctly")
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML; import urllib.parse as u; HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 9: Aliasing a List

Exercise Description

Create a list `a = [1, 2, 3]`, and assign `b = a`. Set the first element of `b` to 99 and show how it affects `a`.

Your solution

```
a =  
b =  
b[0] =
```

Test your solution

```
assert a == b
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 10: Cloning a List

Exercise Description

Clone the list `a = [4, 5, 6]` to a new list `b` and set the first element of `b` to 10 without affecting `a`.

Your solution

```
a =  
b =  
b[0] =
```

Test your solution

```
assert a == [4, 5, 6]  
assert b == [10, 5, 6]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 11: Nested Lists and Aliasing

Exercise Description

Create a nested list `colors = [warm]`, where `warm = ['yellow', 'orange']`. Add `hot = ['red']` to the nested list. Show how appending 'pink' to `hot` affects `colors`.

Your solution

```
warm = ["yellow", "orange"]
hot = ["red"]
colors =
```

Test your solution

```
assert colors == [['yellow', 'orange'], ['red', 'pink']]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 12: Mutating a List While Iterating

Exercise Description

Explain why the following code is problematic. Then, suggest a fix.

Your solution

```
def remove_dups(L1, L2):  
    for item in L1:  
        if item in L2:  
            L1.remove(item)  
    return L1
```

Test your solution

```
assert remove_dups([1, 2], [1, 2]) == []
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 13: Removing Duplicates

Exercise Description

Write a function `remove_dups(L1, L2)` that removes all elements from `L1` that are also in `L2`.

Your solution

```
def remove_dups(L1, L2):
```

Test your solution

```
# Test remove_dups function
L1 = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
L2 = [2, 4]
remove_dups(L1, L2)
expected = [1, 3, 5]
assert L1 == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {L1}"
print("✓ Test passed: Duplicates removed correctly")
```

Debug your solution

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before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 14: List Mutation and Sorting

Exercise Description

Explain the difference between using `sort()` and `sorted()` on the list `L = [5, 3, 8]`.

Store the result in `sorted_L`.

Your solution

```
L = [5, 3, 8]
sorted_L =
```

Test your solution

```
assert L == [3, 5, 8]
assert sorted_L == [3, 5, 8]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code**

before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 15: Using List Methods in a Loop

Exercise Description

Use a loop to sort and reverse the list `L = [7, 2, 9]`. Apply the transformations two times.

Your solution

```
L = [7, 2, 9]
```

Test your solution

```
assert L == [9, 7, 2]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 16: Reconstruct String from Substrings

Exercise Description

You are given a string `s = "data_science_is_fun"`. Split it into individual words and then reconstruct the string by joining the words with a hyphen `-`, but in reverse order.

Your solution

```
s = "data_science_is_fun"  
words =  
reversed_s =
```

Test your solution

```
assert words == ['data', 'science', 'is', 'fun']  
assert reversed_s == 'fun-is-science-data'
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 17: Alternating Split and Join

Exercise Description

Given the string `s = "The_quick_brown_fox"`, split the string at underscores (`_`) and store the resulting list in `split_s`.

Then join the list using spaces (`" "`) and store the result in `joined_s`.

Reverse the joined string and store it in `reversed_s`.

Finally, split the reversed string by spaces and store the resulting list in `reversed_split`.

Your solution

```
s = "The_quick_brown_fox"  
split_s =  
joined_s =
```

```
reversed_s =  
reversed_split =
```

Test your solution

```
assert split_s == ['The', 'quick', 'brown', 'fox']  
assert joined_s == 'The quick brown fox'  
assert reversed_s == 'xof nworb kciuq ehT'  
assert reversed_split == ['xof', 'nworb', 'kciuq', 'ehT']
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 18: List Mutation Inside a Function

Exercise Description

Write a function `append_and_sort(L)` that takes a list `L`, appends a given value (e.g., 10), sorts the list, and returns it. Make sure the original list is not mutated inside the function.

Your solution

```
def append_and_sort(L):
```

Test your solution

```
# Test append_and_sort function
L = [3, 1, 4]
original = L.copy()
result = append_and_sort(L)
expected = [1, 3, 4, 10]
assert result == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {result}"
assert L == original, f"Original list should be unchanged, got {L}"
print("✓ Test passed: Function works without mutating original")
print(f"Original: {L}")
print(f"Result: {result}")
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 19: Mutating Lists Based on Conditions

Exercise Description

Write a function `remove_elements_above(L, n)` that removes all elements greater than `n` from the list `L`. Make sure to handle list mutation properly inside a loop.

Your solution

```
def remove_elements_above(L, n):
```

Test your solution

```
# Test remove_elements_above function
L = [1, 5, 3, 8, 2, 7]
remove_elements_above(L, 5)
expected = [1, 5, 3, 2]
assert L == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {L}"
print("✓ Test passed: Elements above threshold removed correctly")
print(f"Result: {L}")
```

Debug your solution

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```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 20: Aliasing and Function Modification

Exercise Description

Create a list `a = [10, 20, 30]` and an alias `b = a`. Write a function `modify_list(L)` that appends the value 100 to `L`. Check if both `a` and `b` are modified when you pass `a` to the function.

Your solution

```
def modify_list(L):  
    pass  
  
a = [10, 20, 30]  
b = a  
modify_list(a)  
print(a)  # Output: [10, 20, 30, 100]  
print(b)  # Output: [10, 20, 30, 100]
```

Test your solution

```
# Test modify_list function and aliasing  
a = [10, 20, 30]  
b = a  # Create alias  
modify_list(a)  
expected = [10, 20, 30, 100]  
assert a == expected, f"Expected {expected}, got {a}"  
assert b == expected, f"Alias should also be modified, got {b}"
```

```
print("✓ Test passed: Both original and alias modified")
print(f"a: {a}")
print(f"b: {b}")
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 21: String to List Conversion

Exercise Description

Convert the string `s = "Hello, world"` to a list of characters and store the result in variable `result`. Then print both the original string and the resulting list.

Your solution

```
s = "Hello, world"
# Write your solution here
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == ['H', 'e', 'l', 'l', 'o', ',', ' ', 'w', 'o', 'r', 'l', 'd']
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 22: List Join with Comma

Exercise Description

Given the list `l = ['The', 'brown', 'fox', 'is', 'jumping', 'around', 'hello']`, join the elements with ", " (comma and space) and store the result in variable `result`.

Your solution

```
l = ['The', 'brown', 'fox', 'is', 'jumping', 'around', 'hello']  
# Write your solution here  
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == "The, brown, fox, is, jumping, around, hello"
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 23: String Replace Characters

Exercise Description

Given the string `s = "The brown fox is jumping around hello"`, replace all occurrences of the letter "o" with "OO" and store the result in variable `result`.

Your solution

```
s = "The brown fox is jumping around hello"  
# Write your solution here  
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == "The br00wn f00x is jumping ar00und hell00"
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 24: String Remove Characters

Exercise Description

Given the string `s = "The brown fox is jumping around hello"`, remove all occurrences of the letter "o" by replacing them with empty string and store the result in variable `result`.

Your solution

```
s = "The brown fox is jumping around hello"  
# Write your solution here  
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == "The brwn fx is jumping around hell"
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 25: String List Sorting

Exercise Description

Given the list of strings `l = ["kiwi", "apple", "pear", "ananas", "Pear", "Ananas", "0nanas", "!orange"]`, sort it using the `sorted()` function and store the result in variable `result`. Note how Python sorts strings lexicographically (dictionary order).

Your solution

```
l = ["kiwi", "apple", "pear", "ananas", "Pear", "Ananas", "0nanas", "!orange"]  
# Write your solution here  
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == ['!orange', '0nanas', 'Ananas', 'Pear', 'ananas', 'apple', 'kiwi', '']
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 26: List Sorting Comparison

Exercise Description

Given two lists `ln = [4, 90, 67, 58, 13, 28]` and `lm = [4, 90, 967, 58, 13, 28]`, demonstrate the difference between `sorted()` function and `sort()` method. Store the sorted version of `ln` using `sorted()` in `result_sorted`, and sort `lm` in-place using `sort()` method. Store the final `lm` in `result_sort_method`.

Your solution

```
ln = [4, 90, 67, 58, 13, 28]
lm = [4, 90, 967, 58, 13, 28]
# Write your solution here
result_sorted =
# Sort lm in-place
result_sort_method =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_sorted == [4, 13, 28, 58, 67, 90]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_sort_method == [4, 13, 28, 58, 90, 967]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 27: List Reverse Method

Exercise Description

Given the list `lm = [4, 90, 967, 58, 13, 28]`, reverse it in-place using the `reverse()` method and store the result in variable `result`.

Your solution

```
lm = [4, 90, 967, 58, 13, 28]
# Write your solution here
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == [28, 13, 58, 967, 90, 4]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 28: List Slice Reverse

Exercise Description

Given the list `lm = [4, 90, 967, 58, 13, 28]`, create a reversed copy using slice notation `::-1` without modifying the original list. Store the original list in `result_original` and the reversed copy in `result_reversed`.

Your solution

```
lm = [4, 90, 967, 58, 13, 28]
# Write your solution here
result_original =
result_reversed =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_original == [4, 90, 967, 58, 13, 28]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_reversed == [28, 13, 58, 967, 90, 4]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code**

before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 29: List Aliasing Demonstration

Exercise Description

Start with `original_list = [1,2,3,4,5]`. Modify `original_list[1] = 13`, then create an alias `l1 = original_list`. Modify `l1[0] = 89` and `original_list[2] = 113`. Store the final state of `l1` in `result_l1` and `original_list` in `result_original`. Also store whether they are equal in `result_equal`.

Your solution

```
original_list = [1,2,3,4,5]
# Write your solution here
result_l1 =
result_original =
result_equal =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_l1 == [89, 13, 113, 4, 5]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_original == [89, 13, 113, 4, 5]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_equal == True
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 30: List Aliasing with Concatenation

Exercise Description

Start with `l1 = [1, 2, 3]` and create an alias `l2 = l1`. Modify `l1[0] = 99` and `l2[1] = 13`, then concatenate `l1 + l2` and store the result in variable `result`.

Your solution

```
l1 = [1, 2, 3]
# Write your solution here
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == [99, 13, 3, 99, 13, 3]
```

Test your solution

```
assert len(result) == 6
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 31: List Append Method

Exercise Description

Given the list `l1 = [1,2,3]`, use the `append()` method to add the number 4 to the end of the list and store the result in variable `result`.

Your solution

```
l1 = [1,2,3]
# Write your solution here
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == [1, 2, 3, 4]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 32: List Concatenation

Exercise Description

Given two lists `l1 = [1,2,3]` and `l2 = [4,5,6]`, concatenate them using the `+` operator and store the result in variable `result`. Also store the original lists in `result_l1` and `result_l2` to verify they remain unchanged.

Your solution

```
l1 = [1,2,3]
l2 = [4,5,6]
# Write your solution here
result =
result_l1 =
result_l2 =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_l1 == [1, 2, 3]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_l2 == [4, 5, 6]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 33: List Copying with Slice

Exercise Description

Start with `l1 = [1, 2, 3]` and create a copy using slice notation `l2 = l1[:]`. Modify `l1[0] = 99` and `l2[1] = 13`, then concatenate `l1 + l2` and store the result in variable `result`.

Your solution

```
l1 = [1, 2, 3]
# Write your solution here
result =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result == [99, 2, 3, 1, 13, 3]
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

```
from IPython.display import HTML;import urllib.parse as u;HTML('<a href="https://pyth
```

Exercise 34: Nested List Access

Exercise Description

Given the nested list `l = [1, 2, 3, [5, [6, [7, 10]]], [8, 9]]`, access different elements and store them in variables: `result_element_4` (element at index 4), `result_element_3` (element at index 3), `result_nested_1` (element at index 1 of the nested structure at index 3), `result_nested_2` (element at index 1 of the deeper nested structure), and `result_deepest` (the deepest element: 10).

Your solution

```
l = [1, 2, 3, [5, [6, [7, 10]]], [8, 9]]
# Write your solution here
result_element_4 =
result_element_3 =
result_nested_1 =
result_nested_2 =
result_deepest =
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_element_4 == [8, 9]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_element_3 == [5, [6, [7, 10]]]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_nested_1 == [6, [7, 10]]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_nested_2 == [7, 10]
```

Test your solution

```
assert result_deepest == 10
```

Debug your solution

The following cells contain code to generate links to Python Tutor for debugging your code when running the tests. **You need to first run the cell containing your solution code before running the cell containing the Python Tutor link.**

